

And when you passed your examinations,” Khalid continued, “did you say that it happened because you were better than everyone else?”

“No.”

“Did you say it was because you had greater willpower?”

“No.”

“Did you say you deserved success because you had suffered more than the other students?”

Zayd shook his head again. “I said it was a gift from Allah.”

“And that is the connection.”

Zayd frowned slightly.

Khalid leaned forward.

“Many people believe their success belongs entirely to them. They say,

‘I succeeded because I never gave up.’

‘I succeeded because my mind was stronger than my circumstances.’

‘I succeeded because I suffered more than everyone else.’

‘I succeeded because I was born into the right family.’

‘Because of my name.’

‘Because of my position.’

‘Because of my wealth.’

‘Because of my race.’

‘Because of my religion.’”

Khalid paused.

“But they forget something.”